



Subject Vision and Intent: EYFS

Our Vision

At King's Cross Academy, we believe that the Early Years should give every child an exceptional start to their education. Our ambition is for children to leave Reception as confident, curious and increasingly independent learners who communicate well, build positive relationships and have the knowledge, skills and attitudes they need to thrive in Year 1 and beyond.

Our Academy vision, Love Learning Together, begins in the Early Years. We want children to experience the joy of discovering something new, the satisfaction of persevering when something is difficult and the confidence that comes from being known, valued and successful.

Our six KCA values - Courage, Respect, Kindness, Integrity, Endurance and Aspiration - are woven through everyday life in Nursery and Reception. Through relationships, routines, stories, play and carefully planned experiences, children begin to understand what these values look like in themselves and in others.

Our Intent

Our Early Years curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced. It identifies the essential knowledge, vocabulary, concepts and experiences we want children to gain across the seven areas of learning, while recognising that young children learn through exploration, interaction, repetition and purposeful play.

We combine high-quality adult-led teaching with carefully planned opportunities for children to explore, practise and apply their learning independently. Adults know when to teach explicitly, when to model and scaffold, when to join and extend children's play, and when to step back so that children can think, communicate and solve problems for themselves.

Communication and language sit at the heart of our curriculum. In our richly diverse community, we deliberately develop children's vocabulary, listening and spoken language throughout the day. High-quality interactions, stories, songs, rhymes and sustained conversations help children learn to express their ideas, understand others and develop the language they need for future learning.

We place reading at the centre of the Early Years experience. Children encounter a carefully chosen range of stories, poems, rhymes and non-fiction, learning to love books as well as developing the foundations of successful reading. Systematic phonics teaching in Reception builds on children's earlier experiences of language, sound and rhyme, while regular opportunities to talk about and revisit books deepen vocabulary and comprehension.

Mathematical understanding is developed through explicit teaching, purposeful practice, mathematical talk and meaningful experiences. Children build secure foundations in number, pattern, shape, space and measure, learning to notice relationships, explain their thinking and apply what they know.

Our curriculum extends beyond the classroom. Children learn through creative expression, physical development, the natural world and the extraordinary community around King's Cross. Our outdoor spaces, local area, visits and partnerships broaden children's experiences and help them make meaningful connections between their learning and the world they inhabit.

Every Child

We have high expectations for every child. Adults use their knowledge of children's starting points and ongoing assessment to identify what children know, what they need to learn next and where additional support or challenge is required.

Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious curriculum. Adults adapt their teaching, interactions, environments and support so that barriers are reduced without lowering expectations.

Strong relationships underpin everything we do. We work closely with families, recognising parents and carers as children's first educators and valuing what they know about their children.

By the end of Reception, our aim is not simply that children are ready for Year 1, but that they have developed strong foundations for a lifetime of learning: rich language, secure early knowledge, positive relationships, growing independence, curiosity about the world and the confidence to believe that they can succeed.